

Acing Your Job Interview

Turn the nerves into an asset

4 psychology approaches · tips & advice — by EvaTalk

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BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Turn the nerves into an asset

The job interview feels like the moment everything hinges on — and nerves can make you forget your worth. Yet a successful interview isn't only about your answers: it's prepared, and the anxiety can be tamed.

This guide helps you ease the stress, prepare solid answers, and present yourself with confidence — without betraying who you are.

Your intention

An interview you're preparing for (or dreading): _____

The 4 approaches

This guide works your topic through 4 complementary psychology lenses. Read, do the exercises, fill the workbook — at your own pace.

Psychodynamic — understand the root.

CBT — ease the negative thoughts.

Humanistic — reconcile with yourself.

Systemic — act on your environment.

What the interview stirs up

An interview often stirs old fears: being judged, being 'found out', not measuring up. These fears come from your history, not your real skills.

Spotting them means no longer letting them speak for you on the day.

Example

Skilled but terrified of being 'seen through', Sami linked the fear to his history. He went in freer.

My history with judgment

When did I learn to fear being evaluated? What do I fear they'll 'discover'?

The truth of the facts

List 3 concrete pieces of evidence that you're competent for this role.

→ *My fear of judgment comes from my history — not my real worth.*

The thoughts that sabotage

'I'll stumble', 'they'll see I don't deserve it', 'if I fail, it's over'. These catastrophizing thoughts raise stress and throw you off.

Softening them gives you back your clarity.

Example

Sure she'd 'mess it all up', Nia listed her points. On the day, prepared, she was fluent.

Pre-interview journal

Note: the catastrophe thought · a fairer version · a piece of evidence.

Reframe

Turn 'if I fail, it's over' into 'an interview is an experience, not a verdict'.

→ *An interview is an exchange, not a courtroom.*

Presenting without betraying yourself

The best interview is one where you stay yourself: your real strengths, your real motivation. And remember: it's two-way — you're also evaluating whether the company suits you.

You don't have to play a character: your sincerity is an asset.

Example

Instead of reciting a role, Léa spoke about what truly motivated her. They connected.

My strengths & motivation

Write: my 3 real strengths for this role · why this role truly motivates me.

My questions for them

Prepare 3 sincere questions to ask them (you're evaluating too).

→ *I present as I am — and I evaluate too.*

Preparing concretely

An interview is prepared: know the company, anticipate the classic questions, structure your examples (STAR method: Situation, Task, Action, Result), mind your body language, and follow up.

Preparation turns nerves into confidence.

Example

By preparing 3 STAR examples, Sofia answered with concrete stories instead of generalities. It made the difference.

My key answers (STAR)

Prepare 3 examples (Situation · Task · Action · Result) + your answer to 'tell me about yourself'.

My day-of ritual

Note: what I review, what I wear, my timing, my breathing before going in.

→ *Prepared, I turn nerves into confidence.*

Practical tips & advice

Tips & advice

- STAR method for your examples: Situation · Task · Action · Result.
- Prepare 3 quantified wins — they answer almost any question.
- Anticipate the classics: 'tell me about yourself', 'your weaknesses', 'why you'.
- Research the company (site, news, the role).
- Prepare 3 questions to ask them: it shows your interest.
- Breathe before going in, arrive 10 min early, and send a thank-you email after.

To fill in

Pre-interview

The catastrophe thought	A fairer version	A piece of evidence

My STAR examples

Situation/Task	Action	Result

PLAN

Your 4-week plan

Week 1 — Ease what the interview stirs up.

Week 2 — Reframe the thoughts that sabotage.

Week 3 — Clarify my strengths & motivation.

Week 4 — Prepare (STAR, questions, ritual).

Your plan in 3 lines

- The interview I'm preparing for:
- My 3 strengths for this role:
- My 3 questions to ask them:

TO CLOSE

Prepared and yourself, you turn nerves into an asset.

Prepared and yourself. An interview is an exchange.

This guide is a coaching and psychoeducation tool, not a substitute for therapy. If you are going through a hard time, please reach out to a professional or a crisis line in your country. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.